



Good THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church
we seek we serve we celebrate



Advent 2025

Worship in Advent

Christmas is coming! And, for the four Sundays prior to Christmas, we observe the season of Advent. It is a time for Christmas shopping, yes, and a time to make plans for the holiday. It is also a season to prepare our souls for the coming of Jesus. We sing songs of hope and anticipation (we might sneak in a few Christmas carols, but mostly we wait on those until Christmas Eve), and we prepare ourselves as best we can to recognize the spiritual significance of the time, not just the hustle and bustle that comes with the season as well.

We light four candles, one each Sunday. They represent Hope, Peace, Joy, and Love. Sentiments that seem particularly important in our day. We hold on to hope, we work for peace, we bring and receive joy, and love is woven through it all .

We are not providing an Advent Devotional this year, so instead, try to spend some quiet time each day contemplating the significance of the candles each week. Where do you find hope? How do you hold out hope? When do you work for hope? And the same for each of the others.

May you find God already at work in your life, and may you find the space to truly celebrate the birth of Christ.

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♦ **Nov.23** (Traditional)
Christ the King Sunday
Jeremiah 23:1-6
“The Days Are Coming”

♦ **Tuesday Nov. 25**
Thanksgiving Service
7:00 Ecumenical Thanksgiving Service at
Bethel with St. Peder's.

♦ **Nov. 30** Methodicals
1st Sunday of Advent
Communion
Isaiah 2:1-5
“Swords into Plowshares”

♦ **Dec. 7** Methodicals
2nd Sunday of Advent
Isaiah 11:1-10
“The Spirit of God”

♦ **Friday Dec. 12**
Blue Christmas Taizé 7:00

♦ **Dec. 14** Traditional
3rd Sunday of Advent
Isaiah 35:1-10
“The Blooming Desert”

♦ **Dec. 21** Methodicals
4th Sunday of Advent
Isaiah 7:10-16
“A Sign”

♦ **Wednesday Dec. 24**
Christmas Eve
◇ 4:00 Informal with flashlights
◇ 10:00 Traditional Candlelight

♦ **Dec. 28** Traditional
Guided Hymn sing!



United
Women
in Faith

United Women in Faith

Thank you, thank you, thank you for a delightful community event that only YOU all could make possible. The Holiday Bazaar on Nov. 8 was a super treat with an amazing amount of baked goods, Santas, villages, Snowmen, wonderful vintage items and beautiful jewelry along with 18+ vendors their wide variety of wares. The food was great from the egg bakes to the cinnamon rolls, the chicken noodle hotdish to the sloppy joes and.....followed by an amazing number of pies, cakes and desserts. We are truly blessed to have such maker and baker talent at our church.

Your United Women in Faith Leadership group worked very hard to plan and execute this year's bazaar. Please take time to thank Becky Nyseth, Kitty Campbell, Margaret Rawson, Jenny Ammerman, Char Johnson, and Kim Kanuit for the many hours of looking thru our treasure trove of jewelry to find some of special value and to prepare the rest for sale along with baking, cooking, sign making, and pricing. And even more important, thanks to the more than 50 volunteers who contributed to this one day event. Our profits will continue to be sent to the many missions we support locally and internationally that serve women and children.

Coming up in January and February, our annual family musical sponsored by our UWF with profits going to our missions. This year's production begins rehearsals on Sunday, Jan. 4 at 5:30 followed by rehearsals on Mondays, Tuesdays, Thursdays and Sundays with performances the weekends of Jan. 30-Feb. 1 and Feb. 6-8. All ages are encouraged to come; be in a musical with your parents or come as an adult. The show? A good one we've done before: "The Rockin' Tale of Snow White". Director Maureen Trepp and Music Directors Eric Strom and Sue Johnson. Questions? Maureen's cell is 612-387-2520.

Know God only makes good people and prayer can carry us through hard times; use your gifts from God to do good things.

Peace,

Maureen Trepp, *President*



Bazaar prep



Thanksgiving Eve Worship

This year's ecumenical Thanksgiving service has a change of time – we'll be gathering on **Tuesday, November 25** at 7:00 p.m. at Bethel Lutheran Church (4120 17th Ave. S, Minneapolis) There will be a mass choir (which anyone is welcome to join) with a joint rehearsal prior to the worship service at 6:00. We'll have some time to meet each other and renew ongoing relationships afterwards, so if you can help out by bringing a pie to share with others, that would be great. Pies can be home-made or store-bought, and as simple or as complicated as you want. We look forward to seeing you the *night before* the night before Thanksgiving as we come to God with

ADVENT FEST SUNDAY, NOV. 23



Wednesday Night Dinners

Wednesday night dinners are from 5:30-6:15 pm. Everyone is invited to join in these weekly meals for good food and lively conversation. Cost: \$5/person; \$20/family



Advent Fest

Following the worship service, everyone is invited to gather in Fellowship Hall to prepare for Advent:

- Make a family Advent wreath
- Create Christmas tree ornaments
- Color Advent murals

Children's Secret Giftshop - kids can shop for Christmas gifts for parents, neighbors and friends. (All gifts are \$1.00)

-No Sunday School Classes



Christmas Pageant Rehearsal

Wednesday, Dec. 10 at 6:00 pm in the Sanctuary

*Dinner at 5:30 pm (\$5/person; \$20/family)

Menu: chicken tenders, french fries, ice-cream treats



Wednesday Night Childcare

Childcare is offered following the Wednesday Night Dinners from 6:00-7:15 pm. Supervision is offered for kids in the gym and the nursery/preschool rooms while parents continue to eat, socialize, help clean-up, or attend rehearsal or committee meeting.

Minnehaha Playgroup

Babies and toddlers with their caregivers are invited to stop by on Thursday mornings for a time of play and community. Playgroup meets in the 2nd floor nursery and preschool rooms. Follow the "Minnehaha Playgroup" on Facebook for more information.



Parents Night Out

Adult and teen volunteers will host your childr(en) for a fun-filled evening at church. Parents can choose an outing together or on your own. Dinner is provided for the kids.

Cost is \$10/child or \$25/family. Registration closes on Wednesday, Dec. 3.

Registration Link: <https://omella.com/0vpv4>



Children's Choir sang on October 12



MINNEHAHA

YOUTH GROUP

Grades 6th-12th

SUNDAYS
4:00-5:30 PM

Come together for weekly activities, snacks, and fun in community!



On Dec. 7, bring a wrapped white elephant Christmas gift!

No Youth Group on Dec. 28

MINNEHAHA YOUTH SKI TRIP

Friday, Jan. 9-Sunday, Jan. 11
Spirit Mountain in Duluth, MN

All youth (6th-12th) are invited to a great weekend on the slopes on Spirit Mountain. Depart at 4:30 pm on Friday. Return by dinnertime on Sunday.

Trip Includes

2-Day Lift Tickets	Stay at the Sleep Inn & Suites
5 meals	Adventure Zone Passes

Cost \$250



Register By Dec. 17

Rentals Available Online at spiritmt.com

Youth Ski Trip

Registration Link: <https://omella.com/s4y1f>

Mystery Tour!



Shopping for teens for the toy drive!





Minnehaha Winter Retreat January 23-25



Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds

Join us for a getaway weekend of winter fun!

Activities for All Ages

Friday Night Gathering

Saturday Morning Programs

-Adults -Youth -Children

Saturday Afternoon Freetime

Saturday Night Talent Show & Dance Party

Sunday Morning Worship

2 Lodging Options

Lakeview Lodge

Twin beds with shared bathrooms
down the hall

Sunrise Inn

Full sized beds with private
bathroom in the room

Register by Jan. 14



Winter Retreat Registration Link: <https://omella.com/c1pwd>



Halloween parade!



Feeling a Little Blue for Christmas

Sure, there's lots to be joyful about as we approach Christmas, but the shorter days and colder temperatures don't leave everyone full of good cheer. Add in a feeling of frenzy from the rush of the season, and it already begins to feel a little overwhelming. Add in even more, a job loss or change, the loss of a loved one, a change in health, a strained friendship, a move, and it can begin to feel like we are out of sync with the joy being expressed at every turn.

You are invited to rest awhile in silence, in quiet music, and in the glow of candlelight as we observe our Blue Christmas Taizé service on December 12 at 7:00 p.m. Whether you need an opportunity to just sit still for a little bit, or you are looking for a way to acknowledge feelings of loss or depression, join with others for an hour of reflection and rest as we continue to find God's presence in the midst of wherever we are.



FEELING A LITTLE BLUE FOR CHRISTMAS

**BLUE CHRISTMAS TAIZÉ SERVICE
ON DECEMBER 12 AT 7:00 P.M.**



Christmas Eve

Please join us, and invite your friends and neighbors, for Christmas Eve services this year.

4:00 – a child-friendly service featuring music with The Methodicals and flashlights in place of candles.

10:00 – a more traditional candlelight service with choir and organ.

Newcomer Classes

We'll be holding an introduction and orientation class for anyone new to Minnehaha or interested in joining on Wednesday, December 3. Please join us during the Wednesday night dinner at 5:15 p.m. in the Fellowship Hall (dinner is at 5:30). Your meal is on us, and we'll have a table set aside for the class. Just to give us an idea of numbers, please RSVP to becky@minnehaha.org.

Toy Drive Donations Needed

During the first 3 Tuesdays in December, Food Shelf Parents are able to select toys for their children, ranging from babies to teenagers. Parents may choose a toy, a hat and gloves for each of their children. All this is made possible by the generosity of members of Minnehaha. *Every year, parents respond with many smiles and words of thanks in several languages. Then there is "Can I really get a hat and gloves for each of my children?"* Yes, and we even give hats and gloves to the parents who need them.

There are three ways you can help with this mission:

- Buy toys, hats, and gloves and bring them to church. To arrange another drop off time contact Renee Beymer.
- Write a check to the church (put Toys in the memo line) or
- give through our Donate button on the website and designate it for Christmas Toys.

With your help Good Things will, indeed, continue to Happen Here

Adult Faith Forum on Work in Malawi

Join us on Sunday morning, December 14, at 10:45 in Room 310 for a special presentation from Nick Peterson. Nick is a student at the University of Minnesota and is part of an Engineers without Borders project bringing safe water to a school in Malawi. This project was partially funded by the US government, and has lost that funding. If you cannot make it to the presentation, but you want to help support this project, please contact Nick.



Assembling "Birthday Bags"



MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. We gather outside on the 4th Saturday of each month. You can volunteer anytime between 7:15 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up around 7:00, serve the food starting around 8:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us on November 22 for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend!

Please note that in December, we will be serving on the 3rd Saturday of the month because of Christmas.

MINNEHARVEST
a food mission of minnehaha united methodist church

Christmas Pageant

Sunday, Dec. 14 at 4:00 pm with dinner following



All-Church Christmas Caroling

Everyone is invited to join in and share the Christmas spirit with singing! We'll walk around the neighborhood, stopping in front of homes of Minnehaha friends to sing our favorite Christmas carols.

Songbooks provided.

2025 Contributions...So Far!



CONTRIBUTIONS FOR THE MONTH OF OCTOBER WERE \$25,539. WE'LL NEED \$126,341 TO MAKE OUR GOAL.

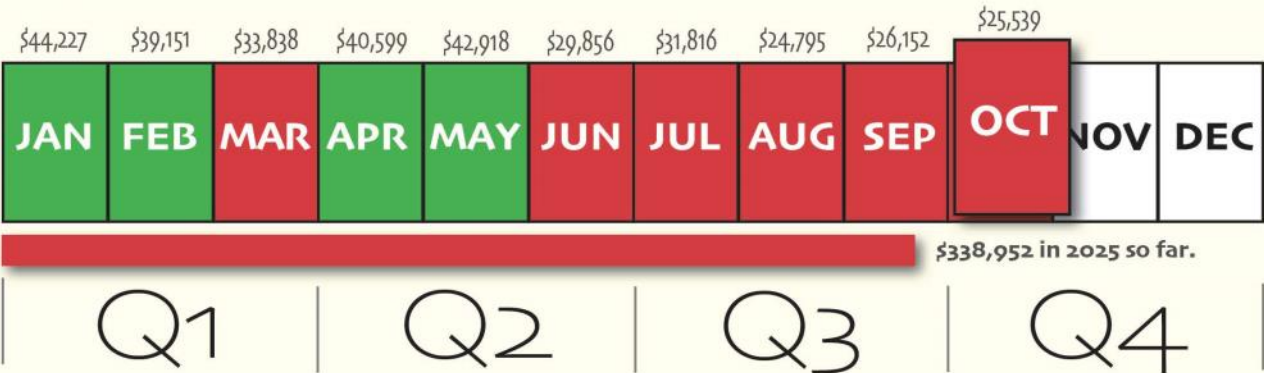
JUST 2 MONTHS LEFT IN 2025!

Our Monthly Contribution Goal is 1/12 of \$465,293 or \$38,774.

CONTRIBUTIONS
SO FAR FOR 2025:
\$338,952

TOTAL CONTRIBUTIONS
GOAL FOR 2025:
\$465,293

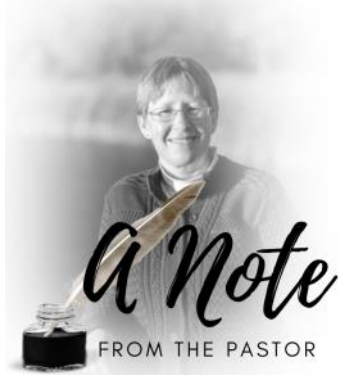
Includes \$23,645 to balance the church budget



4 Easy Ways to Donate to Minnehaha UMC

There are many ways to give to the church: Volunteer, support our food ministries or other missions, or with cash, check, or electronically. A monthly contribution through your bank (EFT) makes it easier for us to budget for the year, and there's just a small added fee. But do whatever works best for you. Know that the church also accepts gifts of stocks, bonds, and other securities, as well as real estate and more. And also consider making Minnehaha UMC a beneficiary in your will or trust. If you need more information on gifting to Minnehaha United Methodist Church, contact the church treasurer or the pastor. Thank you!

Cash		No Fee
Check		No Fee
EFT (Electronic Funds Transfer) via VANCO		0.45% Fee
PayPal (QR Code)		3.5% Fee



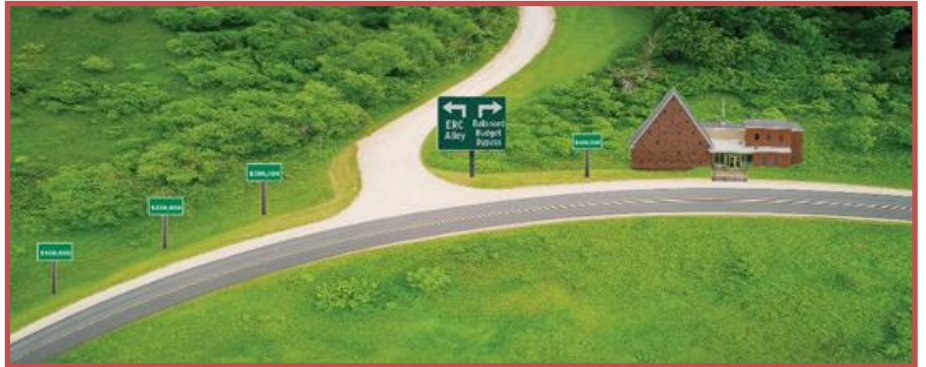
Fork in the Road

Every year it is the same – we are preparing for the birth of Jesus by observing the four Sundays in Advent. At the same time, we are handing out pledge cards and asking for your support for the 2026 budget. You have already had to make your health insurance or Medicare choices, and for those in the working world, financial year-end reports will be due shortly. It seems like a lot to cram into a short period of time, but it is how we do it. In the church world, we have talked about

separating these things out so that they don't all fall in the same time frame, but the reality is that no one is thinking about the 2026 budget in August (well, some of us are, but not many).

Actually, I think Advent is an appropriate time to hand in your pledge for 2026. We take 4 weeks to prepare ourselves,

spiritually, for Christmas Eve. We know Jesus was born over 2000 years ago, but we take the time to observe it every year, acknowledging its central place in Christianity. While no one wants you to take 4 weeks to ponder your pledge to the church, some pondering is appropriate. Where do we want to go in the years ahead? What kind of church will we become? We can expand, contract, move sideways, all those are options. These next 2-3 years will be important for us. How we decide to move and be in our changing country is important. How we do ministry and with what kinds of resources is important. So, take some time to ponder, to pray, and then please do send in your pledge card so that we can make appropriate decisions based on the times we are in and the resources at hand



In Hope,

Becky

Jeanne Ritterson joined us on Oct. 12!



Carli Ann was baptized Oct. 26!





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11/25

Visit us online!
www.minnehaha.org



Steve, our custodian, caught the Northern Lights over the church!